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Reliance JioBook launched in India through Government e-Marketplace
<https://dgit.in/oct22-37>



No more Stadia?
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Cosmic Byte Equinox Kronos

Wireless surround sound at a budget

If you have ever been in the market for budget gaming peripherals, then we're sure the name Cosmic Byte has popped up several times. They've got a pretty decent lineup of budget gaming peripherals, however, their latest lineup of gaming headsets looks to up the ante a bit, with premium build and design, and a lot more features; all while still being relatively pocket friendly. We're talking about the new Cosmic Byte Equinox Kronos wireless gaming headset. Let's dive into the review.

INSIDE THE BOX

The first thing you'll notice as soon as you unbox the Kronos is that it comes with a black and yellow hard carrying case which feels sturdy and well-built. We weren't expecting it, but it's great that it was there. The headphones, and additional accessories are all packed inside the case. Speaking of accessories, we've got a USB C charging cable, a Type-C wireless dongle, a USB A to C converter, a 3.5mm audio cable, a mic cushion, and the user manual. With these accessories you're certainly covered in the compatibility department, the Kronos should work just fine across all consoles, PCs and mobiles.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Cosmic Byte has opted for a more premium build and design with the Kronos and it shows. The pleather memory foam ear cups feel soft and sit comfortably on your ears. The headset has an aluminium frame inside a pleather headband, with memory foam for the part that sits on your head. We did find however that the ear cups are a bit on the smaller side, which might be a problem if you've got large ears. Coming to the on-ear controls, they're all behind the left ear cup. We've got a volume dial that controls volume only on the headset, a mic mute button, and

the power button which also doubles as the surround sound toggle. You've also got the 3.5mm port on the left earcup, while the typeC charging port is on the right ear cup. The Kronos comes with a pull out microphone, which rolls up into the left side of the headphones. The outside of each ear cup has a metal grill, inside which you have a yellow LED of the Cosmic Byte logo, which is in theme with the overall colour scheme. Just the one colour though.

PERFORMANCE

These come with 50mm drivers and supports Microsoft Sonic and Dolby Surround as well. We don't know if the surround works with PlayStation however since we didn't get to test that. It comes with its own software as well, including separate modes for gaming and music and customisable EQ. During our testing, we found the sound quality to be pretty good. There's good bass that doesn't overpower too much, and there's clarity in the mids and highs as well. The testing was all done on the default Cosmic Byte Optimised EQ preset. We found that while the

sound stage itself is not too expansive (it isn't too wide), the imaging is great. So positional awareness is no issue. The microphone however didn't perform too well. The Kronos comes with a pull-out unidirectional ENC (environmental noise cancellation) mic. Voice sounds distant and muffled. This might have to do with the microphone itself being too short, and it certainly left us wanting.

BATTERY LIFE

The Cosmic Byte Equinox Kronos has an advertised battery life of 24 hours.

If you keep the volume at under 70 percent and turn the LEDs off.

We found that we needed to charge the headphones once every 2-3 days which would be fine if it wasn't unusable for the 2-2.5 hours it took to charge. This was one of the things about the Kronos that really boggled our minds was the fact

that they can't be used while charging. Unless you plug in the aux as well.

VERDICT

Cosmic Byte has certainly upped the ante with the Equinox Kronos. It looks and feels premium, is comfortable to use, and even comes with decent sound quality with only downside being the mic. At ₹6,499 it's a solid wireless gaming headset option, which also comes with Dolby Surround support.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 333 grams | SPEAKER TYPE: 50mm Dynamic Speaker | SPEAKER IMPEDANCE: 32Ω | FREQUENCY RANGE: 20Hz - 20,000Hz | MICROPHONE TYPE: Pullout Unidirectional ENC Microphone | TRANSMISSION FREQUENCY: 5.8Ghz | BATTERY TYPE: Li Battery | BATTERY CAPACITY: 1500mAh | CHARGING TIME: 2.5Hrs | BATTERY LIFE: 24H at 70% volume and LED off

CONTACT

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